land and by sea. The attack on Rangoon completely surprised the Burmese and the city fell on May 10, 1825, with little resistance as the Burmese inhabitants had previously fled the city.

Upon hearing that Rangoon fell to the British, General Maha Bandula led a 30,000-strong army from Arakan to retake Rangoon. But before he arrived in August General Campbell was able to attack nearby Burmese ports. On June 10, 1824, the stockades at the village of Kemmendine were attacked, forcing the Burmese to retreat further up the Ayeyarwaddy River. In late July and early August, Campbell was able to subjugate the Burmese provinces of Tavoy and Mergui as well as the coast of Tenasserim.

When General Maha Bandula did arrive he laid siege to the British positions at both Rangoon and Kemmendine. On December 7, 1824, a British counterattack broke the siege and a week later, on December 15, 1824, the British launched an attack on General Maha Bandula, which forced him to retreat up the Ayeyarwaddy River to Danubyu. Major General Sir Archibald Campbell led an advance up the Ayeyarwaddy River and on February 13, 1825, embarked on a two-pronged assault on Danubyu in pursuit of General Maha Bandula. On April 2, 1825, during the battle of Danubyu, General Maha Bandula was fatally injured by rocket fire and the Burmese army was routed. General Maha Nemyo replaced Maha Bandula and on April 25, 1825, launched an attack on the British. After several failed attacks Campbell launched his attack (November 30, 1825–December 2, 1825) and captured Prome, the capital of Lower Burma. Fighting continued until the end of 1825, when General Maha Nemyo was killed and his army destroyed. Campbell then led British forces upriver to the then capitol of Lower Burma, Yandabo, where the Burmese sought terms. Hostilities were concluded on February 24, 1826, when the Burmese signed a peace treaty.

Thus, the first Anglo-Burmese war concluded with the Treaty of Yandabo (1826) in which the Burmese ceded control of Assam, Manipur, Cachar, and Jaintia, as well as Arakan and Tenasserim, to the British. The Burmese were also forced to pay an indemnity of one million pounds sterling and accept a British resident at the Burmese court. A reciprocal commercial treaty was later signed. Despite the fact that King Bagyidaw lost almost two-fifths of his kingdom, he retained the throne.